

COSC 2230 · COSC 3430 — FALL 2026

Sprint 1: What We Learned

Common lessons from the project-proposal reviews, across both classes.

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WHERE WE ARE

What Sprint 1 Was

- The first of four sprint reviews this term
- Low-stakes: a project **proposal**, not working code
- Goal: say what you want to build, and why it matters to you
- Full written feedback on your own project follows within two weeks

LESSON 1

Scope It Down

Define your MVP

Know the smallest version that still answers your question, before you add anything ambitious.

Track your real hours

Most teams underestimate by 4× or more. Budget at least ~2 hours per person, per week.

More people ≠ more speed

A bigger team has more capacity, but also more coordination cost. Plan for both.

LESSON 2 — THE ONE THAT MATTERS MOST

Disclose your AI use — always

- Every proposal needs an AI-use statement — even “none used”
- State what you asked it, and how it helped, or didn’t
- Reflect on your own dependence; don’t just accept its output
- This applies to **every** future submission, not only Sprint 1

LESSON 3

A Link Is Not a Reference

- Pick one citation style — APA, MLA, Chicago, or Harvard — and stay consistent
- A reference should let someone decide, at a glance, whether to look further
- Complete every entry: author, title, year, source

LESSON 4

Check Your Risk Analysis

- A polished, complete-looking list is often AI-written — say so if it is
- An AI-generated list can look complete and still miss real risks
- Ask yourself: is this list actually complete? actually correct?

LESSON 5

Start Small Before Real-World Data

Prove the idea first

Use a small, self-generated dataset to check your logic before anything else.

Real data has its own problems

Source, format, encoding, quality, and timing all add complications of their own.

Then move up

Switch to real-world data only once the core logic already works.

LESSON 6

We're a small company, not a bunch of solo projects

- Read each other's proposals — every team has something worth learning
- No team is strong at everything: coding, planning, writing, scoping
- Borrow good practice from another team, and cite it if you do

LOOKING AHEAD

What's Ahead

- Three more sprint reviews before the final presentation
- Sprint 2 — the literature review — due Fri, Oct 23; we'll discuss it in class Mon, Oct 26
- By the final sprint, you'll have discussed your project many times — keep it focused
- Full, per-project feedback on Sprint 1 is coming within two weeks

One Team's Work Helps Every Other Team

These slides cover what applied to everyone. Every team will get its own detailed, written feedback from me directly — within two weeks.

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